

Chamber Mission

To best serve the unique interests and needs of member businesses and to champion the broader economic vitality of the Metro South region.



Brockton Rox are Back!
Jim Rice • Page 7



Good Day Metro South:
Easton Edition • Page 6



Chamber Welcomes Intern
Colin LeFrancois • Page 6

CONTENTS

Calendar of Events	3
Good News	4
Member Profile	9
New Members	10
Renewing Members	10

Congressman, Economic Development & Town of Sharon Day at Chamber Luncheon, 2/28

Friday, February 28 | 11:45AM - 1:30PM | Sharon Community Center | 219 Massapoag Avenue, Sharon



METRO
SOUTH
CHAMBER OF
COMMERCE
**Good Day
Metro South
SHARON**

Friday, February 28
11:45AM-1:30PM
featuring

**Congressman Auchincloss
and Town of Sharon
Economic Update Panel**

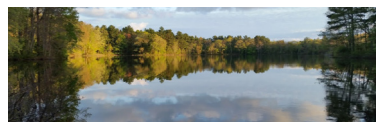
at Sharon Community Center
219 Massapoag Avenue
Sharon, MA 02067



Scan the QR code to register, or visit
metrosouthchamber.com/events, or
call (508) 586-0500 x231



Fred Turkington, Sharon Town Administrator



Lake Massapoag, Sharon Community Center



Premier
Sponsor



Please join us for a Good Day Metro South luncheon Friday, February 28th from 11:45am-1:30pm in Sharon. This event will take place at the stunning Sharon Community Center on Lake Massapoag and feature Congressman Jake Auchincloss. Hear from Sharon Town Administrator Fred Turkington, and

additional speakers to be announced. *This event is sponsored by OCES - Old Colony Elder Services.* Reserve your seat and learn more online at metrosouthchamber.com or scan the QR code on the right. This event will sell out, don't wait to sign up. **More on page 2.**

Woman & Minority Owned Business "Success Stories" Panel, Free Business Resource Expo, Networking, and More! March 13 at Thorny Lea

Thursday, March 13 | 5:00PM - 7:30PM | Thorny Lea Golf Club | 159 Torrey Street, Brockton

**10th annual
multicultural
BUSINESS FORUM
& BUSINESS
after hours**

Premier Sponsor:
**North Easton
Savings Bank**

+ Business Expo!

Thursdays, March 13 from 5:00-7:30pm at
Thorny Lea Golf Club, 159 Torrey Street in Brockton

VALENCIA JACOBS-BROWN
J. BROWN REALTY

ANA ROJAS
RED APRON CHARCUTERIE

Join us Thursday, March 13 from 5-7:30pm for the 10th Annual Multicultural Business Forum & Business After Hours! This triple feature event includes a business resource expo, woman & minority owned business panel, and after hours networking. This is a great opportunity for potential and existing entrepreneurs to learn about helpful resources, network with local businesses, and hear from entrepreneurs who have successful business stories.

The Business Resource Expo: Space is limited and business resource organizations



will be prioritized. Limited space for other organizations is available for \$99. Contact Hannah for more information at events@metrosouthchamber.com or call (508) 586-0500 x231. [All expo participants must be approved, inquire now.] Register to attend this complementary event with the QR code above or visit metrosouthchamber.com/events. **Learn more on page 2.**



February
2025

www.metrosouthchamber.com

Downtown Office Space Available For Rent at the Metro South Chamber

60 SCHOOL ST. BROCKTON

OFFICE SPACE FOR RENT



MULTIPLE
OFFICES
AVAILABLE

CALL CHRIS
(508) 586-0500 x223

Occupant space includes use of:

-Conference rooms for meetings with outside guests, equipped with overhead projectors and TVs for AV needs.

-Access to all training courses, seminars, consulting services, and business resource library available at Metro South Business Assistance Center.

-Hospitality area including refrigerator, microwave, and coffee, tea, and spring water.

-High-Speed Internet ready.

-Access to ample parking close-by and across the street.

-Close proximity to City Hall and downtown shops, services, and organizations.

For more information contact Metro South Chamber President & CEO Chris Cooney, CCE at (508) 586-0500 ext. 223 or email chris@metrosouthchamber.com

Congressman Auchincloss Comes to Sharon - Feb. 28

Friday, February 28 | 11:45AM - 1:30PM | Sharon Community Center | 219 Massapoag Avenue



Congressman Jake Auchincloss is serving his third term representing the Massachusetts Fourth. In addition to his work on the committees for Transportation & Infrastructure and the Select Committee on Strategic Competition Between the United States and China, his areas of focus include healthcare, clean energy, gun violence, and building a strong middle class.

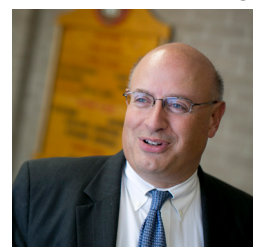
Jake was born and raised in Newton, Massachusetts, the son of a surgeon and a scientist. They showed him the value of curiosity and hard work. From the

moment he could read, Jake loved American history.

After graduating from Harvard College, Jake joined the Marines. He commanded infantry in Afghanistan and special operations in Panama.

Upon returning home, Jake continued his service as a three-term city councilor in Newton. While working at City Hall on nights and weekends, Jake built a career in business, running product development at both a Fortune 100 insurance company and a cybersecurity startup. He has degrees in Economics and Finance from Harvard University and MIT Sloan.

Today, Jake lives in Newton with his wife, Michelle, and their children, Teddy, Grace, and Audrey (along with their Labrador Retriever, Donut). Visit auchincloss.house.gov to learn more.



**Fred Turkington, Sharon
Town Administrator**



Fred Turkington has been serving as the Town Administrator of Sharon, Massachusetts, since August 2014.

In this role, he oversees the town's daily operations, working closely with the Select Board, department heads, and various committees to implement policies and manage municipal services.

Turkington's career in public administration spans several decades. After earning a bachelor's degree from Bates College in Maine followed by a master's degree in Public Affairs from the University of Connecticut, he served as a Presidential Management Fellow at the U.S. Department of Justice. He then held positions as the first Assistant Town Administrator in Vernon, Connecticut, for eight and a half years, Chief Administrative Officer of Canton, Connecticut, for nine and a half years, and the first Town Administrator in Wayland, Massachusetts, for eight years.

Throughout his career, Turkington has been recognized for his commitment to public service and his open-door policy, encouraging citizen engagement and transparency in local government. His leadership in Sharon reflects a dedication to maintaining the town's high quality of life, managing public resources effectively, and fostering community involvement. Visit townofsharon.net to learn more.

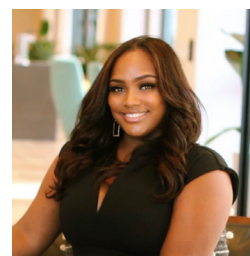
Questions and Season Ticket Holders should contact Hannah McGuire at events@metrosouthchamber.com or call (508) 586-0500 x231 for assistance. Reserve your seat and learn more online at metrosouthchamber.com or scan the QR code on the left. We hope to see you there!



SCAN TO REGISTER

About the Speakers: Multicultural Business Forum

Thursday, March 13 | 5:00PM - 7:30PM | Thorny Lea Golf Club | 159 Torrey Street, Brockton



Valencia Jacobs-Brown
J. Brown Realty



Valencia Jacobs-Brown is a visionary real estate professional, Boston native, and the proud Broker-Owner of J. Brown Realty, a boutique minority- and women-owned brokerage serving Massachusetts, Rhode Island, and international markets. With over 11 years of expertise in residential property management, lending, and real estate sales, Valencia founded J. Brown Realty in January 2024 to deliver personalized, results-driven solutions for clients aiming to build wealth and achieve their dreams.

Valencia began her career in the lending industry, honing her ability to navigate complex transactions and foster meaningful relationships with clients and vendors. Her dedication to education and empowerment has been a consistent theme throughout her journey, as she creates opportunities that promote financial stability and generational wealth.

Recently appointed as a Director for the Greater Boston Association of REALTORS® (GBAR), Valencia is driving innovation and collaboration in the evolving real estate landscape. She has also expanded her vision globally, assisting clients in exploring international markets and investments.

As the industry changes, Valencia combines local expertise with a global perspective to offer unique insights and opportunities. Outside of real estate, she enjoys traveling, cheering on her son at his sporting events, and engaging with her community. Valencia Jacobs-Brown is the trusted expert to guide you toward your real estate goals. Visit jbrownrealty.com to learn more.



Ana Rojas
Red Apron Charcuterie



Ana Rojas, born and raised in Lima, Peru, moved to the United States at the age of 25, leaving her life behind to embrace a new adventure. With over 24 years of experience in international business, Ana's journey took an unexpected turn in 2022 when her corporate role ended due to a company acquisition. Recognizing this as an opportunity for reinvention, she began searching for a way to create something meaningful and personal.

Her passion for tapas, charcuterie, and entertaining inspired the creation of Red Apron Charcuterie. The business name, derived from her last name "Rojas" (Spanish for "Red"), serves as a tribute to her father. What began as an idea to send ready-to-enjoy care packages to loved ones has grown into a labor of love. Ana poured her heart into every detail of the business, from designing the logo to curating her charcuterie boxes.

Each box reflects Ana's dedication to quality, creativity, and connection. She carefully selects products she personally loves and trusts, ensuring her customers experience the joy she finds in creating them. Supported by her husband, who proudly says she is "building her business box by box," Ana has embraced the challenges of entrepreneurship with determination and heart.

Ana remains committed to growing Red Apron Charcuterie and spreading joy, one box at a time. Visit redaproncharcuterie.com to learn more.



SCAN TO REGISTER

BOARD OF DIRECTORS, OFFICERS

Chair of the Board Dan Evans, Evans Machine Co., Inc.	Vice Chair Economic Development Fred Clark, Bridgewater State University
President and CEO Christopher Cooney, CCE, IOM, MPA Metro South Chamber of Commerce	Vice Chair Government Affairs Sue Joss, Brockton Neighborhood Health Center
Chair-Elect George Spilios, Crown Uniform & Linen Service	Vice Chair Community Affairs Doug Smith, Stonehill College
Treasurer Gregory Hart, CPA, Summer St Financial Advisors	Vice Chair Membership Development Mike Lambert, Brockton Area Transit Authority
	Immediate Past Chair Richard Hynes, Barbour Corporation

BOARD OF DIRECTORS

Carol Chin - McDonald's Franchisee	Jay Pike, CPA - Citrin Cooperman
Todd Copeland - Copeland Auto Group	Scott Sanborn - HarborOne Bank
Robert Haffey - Signature Healthcare	Albert Senesie - Victory Human Services
Kelly Mallory - Mallory Headsets, Inc.	Rich Spencer - North Easton Savings Bank
Bill Mitchell - Massasoit Community College	Andrew St. Pierre - Brockton Plumbing & Heating Supply
Matthew Osborne - Eastern Bank	

CHAMBER STAFF (508) 586-0500 Front Desk x 221

Christopher Cooney, CCE, IOM, MPA President and CEO x 223	Development & Retention - NOW HIRING! Membership x 229
Emma Penardi VP of Communications & Special Projects x 222	Theresa Lobo-Albin Finance x 230
Hannah McGuire Programs & Events Coordinator x 231	Colin LeFrancois, BSU Intern

Newsletter Written & Designed by Emma Penardi.
Printing Provided by The Enterprise.



ACCREDITED
CHAMBER OF COMMERCE

CHAMBER MISSION: To best serve the unique interests and needs of member businesses and to champion the broader vitality of the Metro South region.

Metro South Chamber of Commerce
Sixty School Street, Brockton, MA 02301-4087
tel: (508) 586-0500
info@metrosouthchamber.com
www.metroouthchamber.com

ACTION Report **Volume 25 - Issue 2**
(USPS-410630) is published monthly except for combined July/August for \$5.00 per year by the Metro South Chamber of Commerce, Sixty School Street, Brockton, MA 02301-4087. Periodical Postage Paid at Brockton, MA.
POSTMASTER: Send address changes to Action Report, Sixty School Street, Brockton, MA 02301-4087
The Metro South Chamber of Commerce is solely responsible for the editorial content of this publication.
The Chamber wishes to assure our members of our intention to provide universal access to all programs. If you or your employees require assistance in this area, please let us know by calling the Chamber at (508) 586-0500 at least 48 hours in advance.

Calendar Sponsor
SPACE AVAILABLE



CHAMBER Calendar

Networking at events is one of the most effective ways to grow your business!

February

05	Chamber Ambassador Meeting	9:00am
	Virtual meeting via Zoom	
28	Good Day Metro South: Sharon	11:45am
	Sharon Community Center: 219 Massapoag Avenue, Sharon	

March

05	Chamber Ambassador Meeting	9:00am
	Virtual meeting via Zoom	
13	10th Annual Multicultural Business Forum Business After Hours, and Resource Expo	5:00pm
	Thorny Lea Golf Club: 159 Torrey Street, Brockton	
14	Supplier Diversity Office Workshop - Save the Date	
	Metro South Chamber of Commerce: 60 School Street, Brockton	
26	Chamber Board Meeting	12:30pm
	Virtual meeting via Zoom	

April

14	Multi-Chamber Mega Networking!	5:00pm
	Plainridge Park Casino: 301 Washington Street, Plainville	



METRO SOUTH
CHAMBER OF COMMERCE
Leading Businesses.
Leading Communities.

Impact.
It takes the right tools to start or grow a business. And it takes customers to keep business growing.
The Metro South Chamber of Commerce builds strong businesses and communities by connecting you to new customers and suppliers, as well as to those who influence the local economy and quality of life.
Access to the right tools. One more way the Chamber makes an impact.
To join the chamber call 508.586.0500 or visit www.metroouthchamber.com

Note: All meetings are held at the Metro South Chamber Office (via Zoom) or Metro South Business Assistance Center (BAC), Sixty School Street, Brockton unless otherwise indicated.

UP-TO-DATE News

MSBDC Online Training Calendar - visit msbdc.org/training to register

- 2/5: Ways to Improve Your Credit Score
- 2/5: Tech Talks with Rob: Don't Get Hooked! Phishing Protection for Your Small Business
- 2/7: Government Contracting 101
- 2/19: Financials 101
- 2/26: Understanding the Business Loan Process

Fuller Craft Museum presents - "Everybody's Bolos" Opening January 25



Everybody's Bolos features the work of thirty contemporary artists who brought their unique voices to bear on the bolo tie, a type of neckwear traditionally constructed with a cord or braided leather string. The exhibition examines the cultural history and significance of the bolo tie in marginalized communities as well as its expressive potential and relevance as a gender-neutral

Members - send Good News to estratt@metrosouthchamber.com

Sponsored by: Good Samaritan Medical Center

form of personal adornment. Everybody's Bolos encourages visitors to acknowledge, explore, and challenge cultural stereotypes, fostering a broader understanding through the inclusivity and creativity of craft. In addition, Everybody's Bolos cultivates new audiences for contemporary makers who innovate in the realm of the bolo tie. The Fuller Craft Museum is FREE to visit and located at 455 Oak Street in Brockton, Tuesday - Sunday 10AM-5PM. Visit fullercraft.org to learn more.

"Masterworks 2: American Discoveries" - Brockton Symphony Orchestra March 16



Explore orchestral gems and the diverse music of America, from the rural-hoedown (Ruth Crawford Seeger's Rissolty, Rossolty) and touching lullaby (William Grant Still's Mother and Child), to New York swing (Artie Shaw's Clarinet Concerto). Virtuoso clarinetist Matt Griffith brings Copland's magnificent Concerto to life. Visit the local village market as the circus comes to town in Walter Piston's ballet suite, The Incredible Flutist and witness William Schuman's New England Triptych, based on the music of local composer

William Billings, who founded our neighboring Stoughton Musical Society chorus in 1774! Visit www.brocktonsymphony.org to get tickets and learn more.

Brockton Rotary Club Comedy Night - March 21



6:30pm @ Annunciation Greek Church, 457 Oak St. in Brockton, \$50 entry tickets enable Brockton Rotary Club to provide support to the community. Sponsorship opportunities range from \$2000-\$250 packages, contact info@brocktonrotary.org to learn more.

Avon Council on Aging Offers Memory Cafe and Caregiver Support Group

The Avon Caregiver Support Group is designed for people caring for someone with memory loss (second Wednesday of the month 11:30AM-12:30PM). The Avon Memory Cafe is a supportive, safe monthly gathering

for individuals living with changes in their memory or thinking, and their family members and friends. (Last Wednesday of each month 11:30AM-1:30PM). Call to confirm dates (508) 559-0060 Avon Council on Aging 65 East Main Street in Avon.

Planet Fitness Easton Grand Opening Celebration

You're invited to celebrate the Grand Opening of Planet Fitness' newest location in Easton! Check out this clean, spacious club and state-of-the-art Black Card Spa, enjoy complimentary food and refreshments, onsite music, and enter to win several exciting raffle prizes!



Health Care Matters

Good Samaritan Medical Center

235 North Pearl Street, Brockton, MA 02301

508-427-3000

www.bmchealthsystem.org/patients/good-samaritan-medical-center

Boston Medical Center Health System Welcomes Good Samaritan Medical Center and St. Elizabeth's Medical Center into Health System

Boston Medical Center Health System has announced that Good Samaritan Medical Center and St. Elizabeth's Medical Center are officially operating as part of its health system, stabilizing compassionate and equitable care at both hospitals.

"Good Samaritan Medical Center and St. Elizabeth's Medical Center are invaluable resources in their communities," said Alastair Bell,

MD, President & CEO of BMC Health System. "We are proud today to welcome the patients and communities served by both hospitals into our health system. Together, with the highly skilled clinicians and staff at each hospital, we will work to ensure stability and as seamless a transition as possible for patients, with a long-term focus on sustainability across our health system."

Over the past several weeks, BMC Health System has been meeting with the leadership of Good Samaritan and St. Elizabeth's, preparing employees

to join the health system, and putting plans in place to minimize disruption to patient care during the transition. Patients at Good Samaritan and St. Elizabeth's can continue receiving care in their communities with their trusted providers.

The integration of the two hospitals with BMC Health System builds on Boston Medical Center's existing clinical relationship with St. Elizabeth's and deep presence in Brockton through the Brockton Behavioral Health Center. The integration also maintains access

and continuity of care for the many members of the health system's WellSense Health Plan, who are patients at Good Samaritan and St. Elizabeth's.

Visit www.bmchealthsystem.org/patients/good-samaritan-medical-center to learn more.

Good Samaritan Medical Center

Compassionate Care in Your Community

BOSTON MEDICAL CENTER

Save the Date! SDO Workshop March 14 in Brockton

Friday, March 14 | Metro South Chamber of Commerce | 60 School Street, Brockton



SCAN TO REGISTER

March is Women's History Month! The Massachusetts Supplier Diversity Office (SDO) certifies companies as Massachusetts Minority Business Enterprises (MBE), Women Business Enterprises (WBE), Veteran Business Enterprises (VBE), and Portuguese Business Enterprises (PBE).

SDO will host a workshop in Brockton on Friday, March 14 for small business owners to learn about State Certification, Procurement Opportunities, and Business Development Resources.

Member News - Luminosity Behavioral Health Services Receives Blue Cross Grant to Improve Community Connections to Healthcare



The Blue Cross Blue Shield of Massachusetts Foundation (BCBSMA) recently announced \$50,000.00 grant funding to support the Luminosity Behavioral Health Services (LBHS) collaboration with Unlimited Behavioral Health

Services, Inclusion Family Counseling Center, and Choices4Teens Mentoring Group. LBHS is the co-convenor and fiscal agent for this community-based partnership known as SEMPA (South East Multicultural Providers Association).

The purpose of SEMPA is to take collective action to reduce inequities and improve access to behavioral health care in Southeastern, Massachusetts, with a specific focus on communities of color in Brockton. This BCBSMA grant is part of the foundation's Special Initiatives "to improve health care access." "Blue Cross Blue Shield Foundation's grant support is recognition of the critical unmet behavioral health care needs facing low-income families," stated Phoebe Soares, Luminosity, CEO. "Communities of color lack access to culturally sensitive and responsive therapeutic interventions, by trained professionals," she said, "This funding for community-based agencies will help to remedy this dilemma."

SEMPA partners will serve diverse populations of children, youth, adults and families who need support. "SEMPA members will implement cross-agency agreements to ensure the availability of services," said Lou Labissiere, Executive Director, Unlimited Behavioral Health Services.

Adriano Cabral, Executive Director, Inclusion Family Center, explains, "Many of our clients have experienced traumatic life events. This collaboration will increase the pool of multicultural health professionals and help reduce long waitlists." SEMPA will train and certify 60 staff members to provide trauma-specific interventions.

Trayce Hillman, Executive Director, Choices4Teens Mentoring Group, says, "This is an opportunity to continue youth advocacy and create a standardized referral process for youth needing access to services." Choices4Teens is a school-based program and will open doors for SEMPA to partner with school counselors and administrators.

SEMPA is one of five community-based projects in Massachusetts to receive Special Initiatives funding support from the Blue Cross Blue Shield of Massachusetts Foundation. Visit www.luminbhs.org to learn more.

Mega Networking Opportunity, All Are Welcome!

Monday, April 14 | 5:00PM - 7:30PM | Plainridge Park Casino | 301 Washington Street, Plainville

MULTI CHAMBER NETWORKING EVENT AT



Please join us for a night of multi-chamber networking and live harness racing! Monday, April 14th from 5-7:30pm at Plainridge Park Casino, located at 301 Washington Street in Plainville. To register and learn more, visit metrosouthchamber.com/events.

SBA Resources Within Reach; Workshops & More



Feb 7: SBA 101 For Lenders - Leveraging the 7a Loan Guaranty for Small Biz Success

Feb 10: SBA Pathway to Entrepreneurship Workshop + Office Hours

****Feb 13: Norwood Area Capital and Resources Matchmaker [LIVE IN-PERSON EVENT]**

Feb 20: Gov Contracting 101

Visit metrosouthchamber.com/events/workshops to sign up learn more!

"Building a Better Business" Bootcamp Workshop

Tuesday, February 25 | 9AM - 2:30PM | 12 Taunton Green, 2nd Floor, Taunton



Do you feel "stuck" as a business owner?

Are you in search of more business resources and opportunities? Whether you are in...

A. **Start-up Phase** – Defined as the idea stage to under 2 years in business; or
B. **Growth Phase** – Defined as 3-5 years or more in business

...sometimes you don't know what you don't know. Let's talk about the marketing and financial strategies for development and growth.

The Building a Better Business Bootcamp is designed to help individuals grow and stabilize their businesses with tools, resources, and strategies for success. Through education, collaboration, and networking, we will arrive at solutions to move you forward. We discuss the legal, financial, and marketing responsibilities necessary to succeed.

This in-person program will be held on Tuesday, February 25, 2025, from 9 AM to 2:30 PM at NeighborWorks Housing Solutions, 12 Taunton Green, 2nd Floor, Taunton. Coffee and lunch will be provided. Scan the QR Code above to register, or visit nhsmass.org/event/building-a-better-business-bootcamp-taunton-2025

State Auditor, Office of Business Development, Town of Easton, and New Faces Featured at Chamber Luncheon

The Chamber's first event of the year highlighted the Town of Easton as part of a series of community days focused on Metro South regional economic activity. The event featured two panels and keynote speaker, Massachusetts State Auditor Diana DiZoglio, offering attendees valuable insights into the region's future.

A "New Faces Panel" introduced the community to emerging leaders: Stonehill College's new Dean of the Meehan Business School, John Duggan, JD; new Brockton Rox General Manager (more about this on page 7), Shawn Reilly; and House of Possibilities CEO, Katie Terino. These speakers highlighted fresh perspectives and innovative initiatives shaping the Metro South community.

Next, an economic development panel focused on Easton's 300th Anniversary and its impact on regional growth. Featuring Town Administrator Connor Read, Select Board Chair Dottie Fulginiti, and the new Massachusetts Office of Business Development (MOBD) Director for the Southeast Region, Jennifer Menard, the panel underscored the importance of strategic planning and investment in fostering economic vibrancy.

By spotlighting new leadership, celebrating Easton's historic milestone, and providing a forum for collaboration, this Chamber event strengthened connections across the Metro South region. It underscored the region's commitment to innovation, growth, and community-building, positioning Metro South as a dynamic hub of economic activity.

For more information on upcoming events and how to get involved, visit metrosouthchamber.com. Scan the QR code to view more photos, a video, and learn more about Easton's schedule of events for its tricentennial! *Photos courtesy of Rich Morgan Photography.*



SCAN TO READ MORE

Program Sponsored by Stonehill College. Thank you to our panel participants!



Shawn Reilly, Brockton Rox; Sue Joss, Brockton Neighborhood Health Center; Dottie Fulginiti, Town of Easton; State Auditor Diana DiZoglio; Jennifer Menard, MOBD; Katie Terino, House of Possibilities; Connor Read, Town of Easton; and Chris Cooney, Metro South Chamber.



Brockton Area NAACP with Massachusetts State Auditor Diana DiZoglio at the Martin Institute at Stonehill College.



Full house at Good Day Metro South Easton Edition!



John Duggan, JD; Dean of the Meehan School of Business, Stonehill College



Katie Terino, House of Possibilities



(Left) Connor Read and Dottie Fulginiti, Town of Easton; Jennifer Menard, Southeast Regional Director, Massachusetts Office of Business Development.

Workshop Participants Learn How to Use AI for Business Needs at the Metro South Chamber



Tricia White, Small Business Development Officer, NeighborWorks Housing Solutions

Last month, local business owners gathered at the Metro South Chamber for the workshop "Do You Know What AI Can Do for Your Business?" The session explored how AI tools like ChatGPT, Gemini, and Copilot can simplify marketing, boost creativity, and help businesses stay competitive.

Attendees learned how AI is transforming search behavior and improving business visibility. They explored practical applications, including using AI to identify customer search keywords, analyze competition, profile audiences, and create content like blogs and marketing materials.

The workshop also provided insights into the future of AI and how it will continue to shape the business landscape. By the end of the session, participants were inspired to leverage AI as a powerful tool for growth and innovation in their own companies.

The interactive format sparked conversations and encouraged collaboration, leaving attendees with actionable strategies to integrate AI into everyday operations. Participants left with a deeper understanding of how AI can empower small businesses to thrive in the digital era.

Visit nhsmass.org/upcoming-classes to view a list of upcoming classes offered by NeighborWorks.

Metro South Chamber Welcomes Colin LeFrancois, Bridgewater State Senior as New Marketing Intern



Chamber Intern Colin LeFrancois, Bridgewater State University, Senior Marketing Major

The Metro South Chamber of Commerce is pleased to welcome Colin as its newest marketing intern. With a strong background in hands-on marketing experience, excellent interpersonal skills, and a customer-focused mindset, Colin is well-positioned to contribute to the Chamber's mission of supporting local businesses and economic growth.

As a dynamic and resourceful young professional, Colin will assist in various marketing initiatives, helping to enhance the Chamber's outreach, engagement, and promotional efforts. His role will also involve working closely with business leaders and community members to support events,

communications, and strategic initiatives.

Chris Cooney, President and CEO of the Metro South Chamber of Commerce, expressed enthusiasm about Colin's addition to the team. "We are pleased to have Colin join us as a marketing intern. His skills and energy will be a valuable asset to our efforts in promoting business success and community development throughout the Metro South region."

The Chamber, in partnership with institutions like Bridgewater State University, continues to emphasize the importance of internships as a pathway for students to gain practical experience while contributing to the local economy. Colin's role exemplifies the benefits of this collaboration, strengthening both his professional development and the Chamber's ability to serve the community.

Brockton Rox Are Back!!! Boston Red Sox Legend and Hall-of-Famer Jim Rice part of new Ownership



Bob Rivers, Eastern Bank; new Rox owners Bill Janetschek and Boston Red Sox Hall-of-Famer Jim Rice; Mayor of Brockton Bob Sullivan; Brockton Rox General Manager, Shawn Reilly; new Rox ownership Rob Janetschek; and Metro South Chamber President Chris Cooney.

The Frontier League's 16th franchise, located in Brockton, Massachusetts, announced today the franchise has been acquired by Brockton Sox, LLC and will rebrand to the historic and beloved Brockton Rox name for the 2025 season. The new ownership group is highlighted by Boston Red Sox legend and Hall-of-Famer, Jim Rice.

The Brockton professional baseball franchise began as the Rox at Campanelli Stadium in 2002 as a member of the Can-Am

League of Professional Baseball. Last year during its inaugural Frontier League season, the franchise played as the New England Knockouts. As a professional team, they have hosted dozens of professional stars (including current Field Manager Jerod Edmondson) and were an annual league leader in attendance.

Rice was an 8-time MLB All-Star, 1978 American League MVP and multiple Silver Slugger/Gold Glove Award winner who was inducted into the National Baseball Hall of Fame in 2009. He is currently a commentator on New England Sports Network (NESN), the top-rated regional sports network that broadcasts live sports, original content, and award-winning coverage of the Boston Red Sox and Boston Bruins. "I am very excited to be part of the Brockton Rox ownership group," Rice expressed. "As a Massachusetts resident, I am thrilled to be part of a professional baseball organization in my own backyard."

Rice also added the importance of giving back to the next generation of baseball, bringing the Rox together with the countless youth programs in the area. During his time with the Red Sox, Rice was named as an honorary chairman of the Jimmy Fund in 1979, eventually being bestowed with the "Jimmy Award" for his outstanding contributions. His desire to give back has grown exponentially, now stretching to Southeastern Massachusetts.

"Having legendary Red Sox player, eight-time American League All-Star, and Baseball Hall of Famer Jim Rice join our community is not only incredibly exciting, but also a perfect fit for our "City of Champions," said Brockton Mayor Robert Sullivan.

Rice's partners with the Rox are Bill and Rob Janetschek and Shawn Reilly. Reilly was a co-founder of the New York Boulders-now entering their 15th year of operation- where he is partners with Rob Janetschek. Bill Janetschek has been a contributing owner in several minor league franchises, most prominently with the Greenville Drive (Boston Red Sox, Single A) and Salem Red Sox (Boston Red Sox, High A). The retired Chief Financial Officer at Kohlberg Kravis Roberts & Co, his legacy in baseball stretches into Cooperstown, contributing to the "Whole New Ballgame" exhibit in honor of his father, Bill Sr.

"We're excited to now be a part of the great history of Brockton Rox baseball," Team President Shawn Reilly expressed. "I remember when the Boulders came to Campanelli Stadium during our Cam-Am League days. The stadium was constantly full with a great atmosphere and was the toughest place to play in the League. We are certain that we will return that excitement to the fans of professional baseball in Southeastern Massachusetts."

"I'm excited to go back to the name and history within the Brockton Rox," Field Manager Edmondson stated. "When I was here, it was the height of Campanelli Stadium and this amazing fan base. I'm thrilled to get going again under this new chapter and hopefully bring back a championship."

The rebrand is highlighted by a revamped Rox logo. The crest was first introduced in 2011 and incorporates the gloves of Brockton's rich boxing history. Secondary marks include a refreshed type font and a commemorative "Revival Season" logo. K.O. will also return to Campanelli Stadium as Brockton's mascot.

"The decision to re-name our Frontier League professional baseball team the Brockton Rox is a true tribute to our city's rich sports history," Mayor Sullivan added. "I am deeply grateful to the League and the Ownership group for their commitment to Brockton and beyond. With great anticipation, I look forward to what lies ahead for our hometown team and the lasting impact this will have on our City's future."

"We will be spending a good amount of effort focusing on getting the younger generation involved in baseball through baseball camps, school trips, camp days and community outreach in the Brockton area. I look forward to seeing you all on Opening Day on May 16th," Rice said.

The Rox revival at Campanelli Stadium begins on Friday, May 16th against the New York Boulders. Fans can now purchase season ticket memberships by calling the Rox front office at (508) 559-7000 or by visiting brocktonrox.com.

About the Brockton Rox: The Brockton Rox are a professional baseball team in the MLB-partnered Frontier League. The Rox are the 16th franchise of the Frontier League, officially being awarded membership in the fall of 2023. Brockton began professional play in 2002 under the former Can-Am League. The Rox play at Campanelli Stadium, located in Brockton, Massachusetts. Fans and other members of the media can stay up-to-date with all Rox content through their social media channels @BrocktonRox.

The point is
journalism
that gets right
to the point of
the story and
why it matters
to you.



**USA
TODAY** | To the point



Job & Internship Fairs - Connecting with the Workforce



Thursday, April 3 | 12:00 am – 3:00 pm
Tinsley Athletic Center Gym | 131 Summer St., Bridgewater

The MEGA Job & Internship Fair is a great way for employers to meet a large number of potential candidates looking for full-time, professional-level positions as well as internships. The Career Services & Internships Office provides a comprehensive marketing effort for the event so that employers can expect to see hundreds of candidates. This event is open to all Bridgewater State University students, alumni, and the community providing over 120 employers with the opportunity to meet with 500+ candidates from a variety of majors at the undergraduate and graduate levels. Employers attending must have open/anticipated full-time, degree required jobs, and/or academic internships. This event is invite only. Please contact Amy Kirkcaldy at akirkcaldy@bridgew.edu for more information.



Wednesday, May 7 | 4:00 pm – 6:00 pm
Rondileau Student Union Ballroom
19 Park Avenue, Bridgewater

The Education Career Fair is a recruiting opportunity for educational organizations including public school districts, charter schools, private and independent schools, and education focused non-profits. This fair allows school hiring personnel to network with top-caliber teacher, counselor, and administrator candidates from Bridgewater State University and other area colleges. With over 60 school districts and 100+ students and alumni in attendance, this is a can't-miss recruiting event! This event is invite only. Contact Amy Kirkcaldy at: akirkcaldy@bridgew.edu for more information.



February 26 & 27 | 1:00 pm - 4:00 pm | (508) 999-8658
UMD Marketplace | umassd.edu/career/employers/career-fair

The UMassD Spring 2025 2-Day Job & Internship Expo provides an avenue to meet qualified students in all majors seeking jobs and internship opportunities.



April 1 | 1:00 pm - 4:00 pm | (508) 999-8658 | UMD Marketplace
umassd.edu/career/employers/career-fair

Unexpected hiring needs can arise anytime—stay ahead by registering for the Just in Time Career Fair! This event connects you with a diverse pool of talented candidates across all majors, from freshmen to alumni.

ATHENA Award - Honoring & Empowering Women Leaders: Call for Nominations

This June, the Metro South Chamber of Commerce will present the 27th Annual ATHENA Award to an exceptional individual who has achieved excellence in their business or profession, has served the community in a meaningful way, and has assisted women in reaching their full leadership potential.

The ATHENA Awards Program was created in 1982 and has expanded to over 500 cities in the United States, Canada, the United Kingdom, the United Arab Emirates, Russia, and China. The Metro South Chamber of Commerce believes in the values underlying the ATHENA Foundation's philosophy of incorporating the talents and expertise of women into the leadership of our

businesses, communities, and government.

To nominate an individual for an ATHENA Award, or for more information please contact Hannah McGuire at (508) 586-0500 x 231 or email events@metrosouthchamber.com. Nominations are due to the Chamber by May 1, 2025.

- Prior ATHENA Recipients**
- 2024 Beverly Williams, BAMSI
 - 2023 Barbara Arena, Granite State Econ. Dev.
 - 2022 Phyllis Ellis, Brockton Area NAACP
 - 2021 Sheila Sullivan-Jardim, MassHire GBWB
 - 2020 Nancy B. Gustafson, The Charity Guild
 - 2019 Sharon Wolder, Brockton Public Schools
 - 2018 June Saba-Maguire, Brockton Public Schools

Call for 2024 Small Biz Award Nominations



The Metro South Chamber recognizes the achievements and contributions of small businesses and entrepreneurs in creating new jobs and economic opportunities in the Metro South region. We welcome you to nominate businesses for the *2025 Small Business of the Year and Entrepreneur of the Year awards*.

You may nominate your own business or any other business you deem worthy. For nomination forms, call Hannah at (508) 586-0500 x 231 or email events@metrosouthchamber.com. You may include any additional documentation that will help illustrate why the business is deserving of the award. Nominees do not need to be members of the Chamber.

Small Business of the Year Criteria:
50 or less full-time employees (or equivalent); in business more than 3 consecutive years under the current ownership; for-profit business.

Entrepreneur of the Year Criteria:
10 or less full-time employees (or equivalent); in business less than 3 years; a for-profit business.

Companies will be rated on their creativity and imagination in the development of their business, demonstration of growth, and a reflection on internal and external social responsibility.

Nominations are due to the Chamber by April 1, 2025. Recipients will be announced at the Small Business and Entrepreneur Lunch in May.

Prior Small Business of the Year Recipients

- 2024 Medella Dental
- 2023 Healthier You Wellness Partners
- 2022 New England Tortilla / Mi Niña
- 2021 Mallory Headsets, Inc.
- 2020 South Shore SoftWash, LLC
- 2019 Immerse Agency
- 2018 Just Desserts Bakery & Cafe
- 2017 Wood Palace Kitchens
- 2016 Strange Planet Printing
- 2015 Maguire's Bar & Grill
- 2014 JM Pet Resort
- 2013 Solex Payroll Systems, Inc.
- 2012 Vicente's Tropical Grocery
- 2011 McGuigan's Pub

Prior Entrepreneur of the Year Recipients

- 2024 BinStar
- 2023 Brockton Beer Company
- 2022 Grand Flourish Collective
- 2021 Fusion Dolls
- 2020 Empower Nutrition
- 2019 LAUNCH Web Marketing
- 2018 Shovel Town Brewery
- 2017 Epicure Wine & Jazz Bar
- 2016 Elvera's Cafe
- 2015 The Sound Lab
- 2014 JJ's Caffe
- 2013 SKy8 Shrimp Farm, LLC
- 2012 Sparky's Import Repair
- 2011 Elie Baking Corp.

"We develop, support and honor women leaders from the classroom to the boardroom."



Annual Labor & Employment Law Update with MHTL

Thursday, April 17 | 8:30am | Granite Links | 100 Quarry Hills Drive, Quincy



Murphy, Hesse, Toomey, & Lehane, LLP in collaboration with the Metro South Chamber of Commerce, Neponset River Chamber of Commerce, South Shore Chamber of Commerce, and Quincy Chamber of Commerce is proud to announce that we will be hosting our annual Labor & Employment Law Update on Thursday, April 17th at 8:30 a.m at the Granite Links, at 100 Quarry Hills Drive in Quincy. Please save the date, more information to be announced.

Reach Your Audience Through the Metro South Guide



The Metro South Chamber's Regional Guide and Member Directory is designed to encourage in-state support for our local businesses, especially those effected by the pandemic; shop local, and support small businesses!

While you are here, you can visit the extraordinary Fuller Craft Museum, enjoy

the acclaimed Brockton Symphony Orchestra, cheer on the Brockton Rox at Campanelli Stadium, and grab a drink at the new Brockton Beer brewery downtown! With plentiful hotel rooms and within easy reach of Boston, Providence, Plymouth and Cape Cod, you will find many fun shopping experiences, peaceful parks, dynamic sporting events and rich cultural activities all within reach. If you are new to this region, we aim to inform you. If you live here, we want to remind you. If you do business here, we wish to thank you.

The Metro South Guide is distributed to thousands of key decision makers and community stakeholders, including all members, prospective members, town halls, libraries, legislators, hotels, museums, and more. Want your business to be included? Call (508) 586-0500 x222.

Ad Size	Dimensions	Investment
Enhanced Listing	--	\$237
1/6 page ad	3.5" x 3"	\$473
1/3 page ad	3.5" x 6.5"	\$604
1/2 page ad	7.25" x 4.75"	\$939
Full page ad	7.25" x 10"	\$1,884
Inside Front Cover	7.25" x 10"	\$2,619
Inside Back Cover	3.5" x 11"	\$2,619
Back Cover	3.5" x 11"	\$3,354
Your Business Logo on the Front Cover, Plus Full Page Ad Inside	8.5" x 11"	\$4,14

State Treasurer’s Office of Economic Empowerment Offers Worth & Wealth Seminars en Español



LOS SEMINARIOS DE VALOR Y DINERO
Feb 5: Más Allá de los Números
Feb 12: Estableciendo Metas Financieras
Feb 19: Crédito 101
Feb 26: Resiliencia Financiera

REGISTRO: mass.gov/orgs/office-of-economic-empowerment/events

Member Profile - MassHire Greater Brockton Workforce Board (MassHire GBWB)



MassHire Greater Brockton Workforce Board (MassHire GBWB)
34 School Street, Brockton, MA 02301
(508) 584-3234
masshiregbwb.org

Year Established: Brockton Area Workforce Board (BAWIB) was incorporated in 2001 and rebranded as MassHire GBWB in 2019.

Products or Services: We are one of 16 Workforce Boards statewide working to build links between the labor force and business community.

Number of Employees: 15

What is unique or special about your firm and the products and services you offer? MassHire GBWB works with employers to bring training resources to the region and to foster collaborations for regional workforce priorities. Our services are FREE for jobseekers and businesses alike!

What is your market area? Abington, Avon, Bridgewater, Brockton, East Bridgewater, Easton, Hanson, Stoughton, West Bridgewater, Whitman

What markets do you serve? People seeking training and/or employment and employers seeking people to train and/or hire.

What is your main business objective concerning your customers and the business community? Working with business & community leaders, employers, educators, workforce partners and more, we convene, collaborate & construct workforce development initiatives for our region.

Anything additional we should know about your company? We’ve recently launched a Clean Energy Career Awareness Program which will help expose young people to viable and rewarding career pathways in this emerging industry. We are seeking connections with local employers and industry leaders within the Clean Energy realm. Contact us today to partner on this important initiative!

RENEWING Members!

Thank you!

Asaman, Inc.
 Baypointe RehabCenter, LLC
 Bridgewater Pediatrics, LLC
 Brockton Area Transit Authority
 Brockton Plumbing & Heating Supply
 Business Development Strategies
 Capstone Communities
 Chin Management/McDonald's
 Combined Insurance of America
 Cushman Insurance Group
 Douglas A. King Builders, Inc.
 Eastern Bank
 Energy Conservation, Inc.
 Fisher College
 Grant's Rental
 Home Health Resources, Inc.
 House of Possibilities
 J. Brown Realty
 J. Frank Conley, Inc.
 M. Donahue Associates, Inc.

McCaul Land Title Company
 Medella Dental, PLLC
 Minuteman Press of Canton
 Residence Inn by Marriott
 Boston/Brockton
 School on Wheels of Massachusetts
 South Shore Bank
 Stephco Cleaning and Restoration
 Trans Courier Systems, Inc.
 Trinity Development and Management
 Trinity Development and Management
 Unified Family and Youth Network,
 United Way of Greater Plymouth County
 Verizon Communications
 Viking Sheet Metal, Inc.
 William M. Callahan Realty Group/
 Keller Williams Realty

WELCOME New Members!

Reinvesting in Our Community

Botera

Chyanne Bessette
 747 Centre Street
 Brockton, MA 02302
 (508) 254-6265
 boterama.com
 Retail

Etienne Consulting

Gadinet Etienne
 33 Dover Street, Suite 205B
 Brockton, MA 02301
 (857) 220-9599
 etienneconsulting.net
 Consultants

Senior First Elevation Homecare Agency, INC

Judith Nelson
 75 North Main Street, Suite 645
 Randolph, MA 02368
 (551) 358-3354
 Home Health Care

To promote your business and support your community, contact New Member Services

(508) 586-0500 x 229

membership@metrosouthchamber.com

SEED Corp. Offers Micro and Small Loan Programs



FAST TRACK LOANS

Up to \$25,000 for start-up and existing businesses at 7% fixed

MORE INFO



MICRO AND SMALL LOANS

Micro Loans up to \$50,000 and Small Loans up to \$350,000 at 6-7% fixed with flexible terms



SBA 504 LOANS

Real Estate or Machinery and Equipment Loans up to \$5.5 million at low, fixed rates



Use of funds: Working capital; leasehold improvements/built-outs; inventory/supplies; real estate acquisitions (owned-occupied); furniture, fixtures, and equipment; refinancing business credit card debt. Call (508) 822-1020 x 312 or visit SEED Corp online at www.seedcorp.com

Own A Small Biz? Thinking of Starting One? Call SCORE!



To succeed, you have to stay ahead of the competition; whether you're looking for a business direction sheet or working to tap into value creation, connect with a SCORE mentor to help you! If you're just starting a business, SCORE mentors can provide the practical action plan, education and tools you need to open your doors and establish a customer base.

Already own a business? Our volunteer mentors can help identify ways to increase profit, improve employee and customer satisfaction, and achieve work/life balance. With SCORE, you can have the honest, confidential and sometimes tough conversations about raising money, motivating your team, marketing your business, and other topics.

Take advantage of their **free** live webinar series! Learn more by visiting www.score.org, www.sema.score.org, www.boston.score.org, or by calling (508) 587-2673. Ahead for the month and beyond...

February 4: Email Marketing Strategies to Boost Your Business Growth

February 4: Business Essentials Series - Taunton

February 5: Win Customers With Your Website

February 6: Strategies and Tips for Outsourcing for Small Business Owners

February 13: Bookkeeping Basics for Small Business Owners

February 18: Small Business Marketing - Planning and Creating Engaging Content

February 25: Mastering Small Business Taxes - A Startup Guide to Taxes

March 1: Marketing Your Business in The Digital World Workshop

Now Hiring: Membership Development & Retention

WE ARE HIRING

Are you positive, organized, committed to business & community development, and have a love for the greater Brockton area?

Please send resume with cover letter and references to: info@metrosouthchamber.com

OPEN POSITIONS

JOIN OUR TEAM (:

• Development & Retention

Metro South Chamber of Commerce • 60 School Street, Brockton, MA 02301
www.metroouthchamber.com • info@metrosouthchamber.com

Are you positive, organized, committed to business & community development, and have a love for the greater Brockton area? Join our team as Membership Development Specialist! Email resume and cover letter to info@metrosouthchamber.com.

Job Summary: The Membership Development Specialist is responsible for promoting the Chamber and its products and services to prospective and existing members. Sales of membership to prospects and retention of existing members are the key functions of this position. They will identify prospects, determine their needs, communicate the Chamber's value and establish professional relationships with area businesses and organizations. The Membership Development Specialist must be able to conduct "high-level" business interactions independently and as part of a coordinated team.

This is an excellent opportunity to invite businesses to join and engage in the chamber community by strengthening local ties in Brockton and beyond, while gaining a deep understanding of regional economic progress and the competitive developing future of the Metro South region.

Access to Capital for Massachusetts Businesses



Massachusetts Growth Capital Corporation (MGCC) functions as a one-stop resource for debt financing for small businesses. MGCC drives economic growth through access to alternative funding, resources, and individualized services to identify and structure

solutions tailored to each small business in Massachusetts. The purpose of MGCC is to create and preserve jobs at small businesses. MGCC also works to promote economic development throughout the Commonwealth, with special paid attention to business needs in underserved areas and Gateway Cities. Their services include small business lending from \$100,000-\$200,000; microloans from \$5,000-\$100,000; small business technical assistance grant program for non-profit assistance providers; microlending operations support & CDFI lending capital matching funds grant program; and the biz-m-power crowdfunding matching grant program. Visit empoweringsmallbusiness.org to learn more.

Chamber Affiliation News & Events

To become an affiliate organization of the Chamber, contact Christopher Cooney at (508) 586-0500 x 223 or e-mail chris@metrosouthchamber.com.

The Avon Industrial Park Association is a non-profit group seeking to advance the advocacy and business of its members in public and private affairs. Membership is open to all companies who operate within the confines of Avon Industrial Park in Avon, Massachusetts. For more information please visit avonindustrialpark.org.

The Bridgewater Business Association (BBA) promotes unity between local government and the business community and is committed to promoting goodwill among business owners, operating in an ethical manner, and supporting the community they serve. Visit bridgewaterbiz.biz for more information.

The East Bridgewater Business Association (EBBA) was founded in 1993 "to promote a healthy business environment in East Bridgewater and to provide services to assist its members including education, networking and fellowship." Please visit jointheebba.com for more information.

The Easton Chamber of Commerce is a non-profit 501(c)(6) membership organization representing business and professional people. The Easton Chamber of Commerce mission is to unite, guide and support Easton businesses with the goal of increasing economic opportunities and fostering a healthy business climate. Visit easton-chamber.com to learn more.

The Norwell Chamber of Commerce's mission is to promote the civic, economic and social welfare of its members and the Town of Norwell. They actively assist the Chamber members with the challenges of business growth, management and entrepreneurship. Visit norwellchamberofcommerce.com for more information.

The South Shore Women's Business Network (SSWBN), established in 1991, was the inspiration of six women who felt that the needs of women in business were not being met by traditional organizations. They further believed there was a need for an organization that would provide networking opportunities to women and business owners on the South Shore. Visit sswbn.org for more information.

Small Business Resource; We Speak Portuguese!



Theresa Lobo-Albin, Small Business Assistance



Theresa Lobo-Albin on the chamber staff is fluent in Portuguese. She is available to communicate with businesses that may require help in learning about various business assistance programs serving entrepreneurs, businesses and non-profits throughout the region.

Theresa holds a degree in business and accounting and has worked with many small businesses from numerous industries over her career in accounting.

The Chamber (in partnership with many regional, state, and federal resources) operates the Metro South Business Assistance Center and Thomas Edison Business Incubator in support of business development. Many of the BAC resources can be found online and are being offered remotely, including one-on-one coaching through SCORE

Counselors.

To learn more about business assistance resources in English and Portuguese contact Theresa Lobo-Albin at finance@metrosouthchamber.com or call (508) 586-0500 x 230. To learn more about the Business Assistance Center (BAC) and available business resources, visit www.metroouthchamber.com/resources/business-assistance. Individual counseling is available by appointment.

Federal, State, and Regional Resources for Businesses

The Metro South Chamber is dedicated to providing support for our business community now more than ever - we're here for you. Below, please find an extensive list of federal, state, and regional resources available to everyone interested in business.

Brockton Redevelopment Authority
Contact: Rob May
(508) 586-3887

Center for Women & Enterprise
Contact: Berlhey Narcisse
(617) 536-0700

Massachusetts Office of Business Development (MOBD)
Contact: Alexandra Husted
(617) 872-9926

Massachusetts Small Business Development Center Network
Contact: Anne Fenton
(508) 673-9783

Massachusetts Supplier Diversity Office (SDO)
Contact: John Fitzpatrick
(617) 720-3300

MassDevelopment
Contact: Kelly Arvidson
(508) 678-0533

MassHire Greater Brockton Workforce Board
Contact: Jason Hunter
(508) 584-3234

MassHire Greater Brockton Career Center
Contact: John Murray
(508) 513-3400

Old Colony Planning Council
Contact: Mary Waldron
(508) 583-1833 ext. 202

SCORE Business Counselors
Contact: Peter Smith
(508) 587-2673

South Eastern Economic Development (SEED) Corporation
Contact: Sue Murray
(508) 822-1020

U.S. Small Business Administration
Contact: Shelly Gillis
(617) 565-5590

Copper Mill



66 Long Wharf, Suite 403, Boston, MA 02110
(914) 506-9956 • coppermill.com

Boston-based commercial & residential real estate developer specializing in the development of mixed-use urban assets.

Planet Fitness Easton



690 Depot Street, North Easton, MA 02356
(508) 297-2301 • planetfitness.com/gyms/easton-ma

We strive to create a workout environment where everyone feels accepted and respected. That's why at Planet Fitness Easton, MA, we make sure our club is clean and welcoming, our team members are friendly, and our certified trainers are ready to help. Whether you're a first-time gym user or a fitness veteran, you'll always have a home in our Judgement Free Zone®. Download our free PF mobile app and get access to hundreds of workout videos, a personal fitness tracker, partner rewards and discounts and more.

Sungaze Home Improvement



71 Prospect Street, Brockton, MA 02301
(857) 389-0328 • sungazeroofting.com

At Sungaze Home Improvement Inc., we are dedicated to providing top-notch Roofing, Siding, Gutters, and Home Improvement services for both Residential and Commercial properties. With 10 years of experience and a commitment to exceptional quality, we take pride in every project, ensuring your home or business is protected and looks its best. From insurance claims to new installations, our team is here to make the process seamless and stress-free. Trust your next project to local experts who prioritize customer satisfaction and quality craftsmanship.

Join the Chamber!

YOUR BUSINESS PROFILE HERE...

...When Your Join the Chamber!
Call us at (508) 586-0500 or
email info@metrosouthchamber.com

60 School Street, Brockton
(508) 586-0500 • metrosouthchamber.com

Join the Chamber and network your business to success! The Chamber hosts informative meetings, networking events, and puts you in touch with your legislators. We also offer marketing and advertising opportunities, referrals, publicity, and exposure.

Call to learn more today!

Visit metrosouthchamber.com/membership/join



Starting a Business?

Need help starting your business?
Looking for money to start your business?

The Metro South Business Assistance Center Can Help!

COUNSELING: Individual counseling is available by appointment for start-up and existing businesses. Counselors are working or retired professionals, highly experienced and willing to share their knowledge in financing, marketing, management, and more.

REFERENCE MATERIALS: An outstanding collection of reference materials that include hundreds of fully detailed, step-by-step guides for every aspect of starting and maintaining a small business.

ACCESS: To computer and business-related software, including QuickBooks Pro, Business Plan Pro, Loan Builder, Microsoft Office, and more.

EDUCATION: Workshops include QuickBooks, Writing a Business Plan, SEED Commercial, Social Media Series, DCAMM Certification, and more.

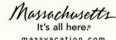
(508) 586-0500 metrosouthchamber.com/resources/business-assistance.

Major Sponsors:



When Metro South is Home, Everything's Within Reach

Hundreds of Dining Options • Great Conference Space
Over 500 Hotel Rooms • Many Parks & Lakes



The Metro South region offers the best of all worlds; cultural and corporate advantages, natural beauty, and the serenity of historic New England.

The region features **top notch education**, including three institutes of higher education, **exceptional health care** facilities, including four major hospitals. **Rich in culture**, the region is also home to symphonies, a craft museum, children's museum, and various historic museums. It also contains many **recreational activities**, including baseball outings, golfing and many parks and lakes for walking, biking, and fishing. With over 500 hotel rooms, the Metro South region is a **great place to stay** and competitive housing costs offer affordable and varied living opportunities.

Whether for Business or Pleasure, The Metro South region provides exceptional value in the heart of Eastern Massachusetts, centrally located between Boston, Providence, Plymouth and Cape Cod. *Ride the rail to Boston in only 35 minutes!* Call 508.586.0500 for your free map.



Metro South Regional Economic Development Organization
For more info, contact the Metro South Chamber of Commerce,
508.586.0500 • www.metroouthchamber.com



BUSINESS EVENTS *Planner*

February 28 Good Day Metro South: Sharon 11:30AM - 1:30PM Sharon Community Center 219 Massapoag Avenue, Sharon, MA 02067 Featured Speakers: Congressman Jake Auchincloss, Town of Sharon Administrator, Fred Turkington. Additional speakers TBA. Register: metrosouthchamber.com/events	March 13 10th Annual Multicultural Biz Forum, After Hours, and Expo 5:00PM - 7:30PM Thorny Lea Golf Club 159 Torrey Street, Brockton MA 02301 Featured Speakers: Valencia Jacobs-Brown, J. Brown Realty; Ana Rojas, Red Apron Charcuterie, and more. Register: metrosouthchamber.com/events	March 14 SDO Workshop 10:00AM - 12:30PM Metro South Chamber of Commerce 60 School Street, Brockton, MA 02301 Join the Massachusetts Supplier Diversity Office (SDO) and the Executive Office on Economic Development (EOED) to learn about Commonwealth programs for small businesses and resources to help your business succeed! Register: metrosouthchamber.com/events	April 14 Multi-Chamber Mega Networking 5:00PM - 7:30PM Plainridge Park Casino 301 Washington Street, Plainville, MA 02762 Expand your net-worth by growing your network! Register: metrosouthchamber.com/events
--	---	---	---